

This document is not for investors yet.

This is the **Pre-Alpha GDD (Game Design Document)** that both Sai and Cherry will use while developing.

PROJECT PALINGENESIS

PRE-ALPHA GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT V0.1

1. GAME OVERVIEW

Genre

Co-op Survival Extraction Horror

Setting

A remote prehistoric research island has suffered catastrophic containment failure.

Dinosaurs have reclaimed the island.

Players are stranded survivors attempting to escape before the ecosystem completely collapses.

The island no longer belongs to humanity.

Players must survive against:

- dinosaurs
- weather
- environmental hazards
- limited resources
- ecosystem chain reactions

The experience should feel like:

"Surviving inside a living prehistoric disaster zone."

2. CORE GAMEPLAY LOOP

Primary Loop

Explore



Gather Information



Avoid Dinosaurs



Complete Objectives



Unlock Escape Route



Reach Extraction



Escape or Die

Example Match

Player enters jungle.



Hears distant raptor calls.



Finds fuel canister.



Restores generator.



Generator noise attracts predators.



Raptor pack investigates.



Player escapes through swamp.



Reaches extraction zone.



Final dinosaur encounter.



Escape or death.

3. CORE DESIGN PILLARS

Pillar 1

Fear Through Uncertainty

Players should never feel safe.

Pillar 2

Dinosaurs Behave Like Animals

Not monsters.

Not zombies.

Wildlife.

Pillar 3

Sound Creates Danger

Noise has consequences.

Pillar 4

The Island Is Alive

Weather and ecosystems react dynamically.

Pillar 5

Multiple Escape Options

Players choose their own survival path.

4. PLAYER SYSTEMS

Movement

Player can:

- Walk
 - Sprint
 - Crouch
 - Jump
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Stamina

Consumed by:

- sprinting
- climbing
- swimming

Low stamina increases vulnerability.

Flashlight

Used for navigation.

Pros:

- visibility

Cons:

- easier detection
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5. DINOSAUR BEHAVIOR SYSTEM

Core Philosophy

Dinosaurs are wildlife.

They do not always attack.

They may:

- observe
 - stalk
 - investigate
 - retreat
 - defend territory
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Sensory System

Every dinosaur has:

Hearing

Reacts to:

- footsteps
 - sprinting
 - gunshots
 - generators
 - voice chat
 - vehicles
-

Sight

Affected by:

- distance
 - foliage
 - weather
 - movement
-

Territory

Dinosaurs defend territory.

Entering nests increases danger.

Emotional States

Every dinosaur tracks:

State	Effect
Calm	normal behavior
Curious	investigates
Hunting	actively stalks
Territorial	protects area
Fearful	retreats
Aggressive	attacks

6. RAPTOR DESIGN

Role

Primary predator.

Creates tension and paranoia.

Behavior

- hunts in packs
- circles prey
- uses ambushes

- investigates sounds
-

Special Ability

Shadow Tracking

Remembers player's last location.

Searches nearby area.

Emotional Goal

Player should think:

"Something is watching me."

7. T-REX DESIGN

Role

Force of nature.

Not a normal enemy.

Behavior

- patrols territory
 - reacts to loud noises
 - attacks disturbances
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Warning Signs

Before appearance:

- distant roar
 - shaking ground
 - moving trees
 - vibrating water
-

Emotional Goal

Player should think:

"We need to leave now."

8. ENVIRONMENT DESIGN

Jungle

Purpose:

- stealth gameplay
- ambushes
- raptor territory

Features:

- dense foliage
- low visibility
- mud

Swamp

Purpose:

- slow movement
- uncertainty

Features:

- fog
- dark water
- hidden predators

Research Facility

Purpose:

- horror
- objectives

Features:

- flickering lights
- alarms
- containment failures

Extraction Zone

Purpose:

- final objective

Features:

- open exposure
 - predator pressure
-

9. SOUND SYSTEM

Core Mechanic

Every sound creates risk.

Noise Values

Action	Noise
Crouch	5
Walk	15
Sprint	40
Generator	80
Gunshot	100
Vehicle	150

Result

Noise can trigger:

- investigation
 - stalking
 - attacks
 - ecosystem reactions
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10. WEATHER SYSTEM

Weather affects gameplay.

Not visuals only.

Rain

Effects:

- reduces visibility
 - masks footsteps
-

Thunderstorm

Effects:

- hides predator sounds
 - distorts hearing
-

Fog

Effects:

- reduces sight distance
 - increases tension
-

Wind

Effects:

- moves foliage
 - creates false movement cues
-

11. ESCAPE ROUTES

Players can choose escape methods.

Route 1: Helicopter

Requirements:

- restore power
- activate radio tower

Advantages:

- fastest

Disadvantages:

- extremely loud

- attracts predators
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Route 2: Boat

Requirements:

- repair dock
- gather fuel

Advantages:

- quieter

Disadvantages:

- water predators
-

Route 3: Mountain Beacon

Requirements:

- climb mountain
- activate beacon

Advantages:

- avoids water

Disadvantages:

- weather exposure
 - flying predators
-

Route 4: Underground Transit

Requirements:

- restore underground systems

Advantages:

- hidden

Disadvantages:

- confined spaces
 - close encounters
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12. PROGRESSION SYSTEM

Early Game

Environment dominates.

Threats:

- small predators
- limited encounters

Goal:

- exploration
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Mid Game

Island becomes unstable.

Threats:

- larger predators
- storms
- migration events

Goal:

- route preparation
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Late Game

Full ecosystem escalation.

Threats:

- apex predators
- extraction pressure

Goal:

- survive and escape
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13. WIN CONDITION

Player reaches extraction.

Island successfully escaped.

14. FAIL CONDITION

Player dies due to:

- dinosaur attack
- environmental hazard
- failed extraction

PRE-ALPHA MVP SCOPE (FIRST MONTH)

Only build:

- ✓ Character Movement
- ✓ Flashlight
- ✓ Small Jungle Map
- ✓ One Raptor AI
- ✓ Sound Detection
- ✓ One Objective
- ✓ One Extraction Point
- ✓ Death System

Do NOT build yet:

- ✗ Multiplayer
- ✗ Open World
- ✗ T-Rex
- ✗ Vehicles
- ✗ Inventory System
- ✗ Advanced Crafting
- ✗ Multiple Escape Routes